

Key Governance Debates



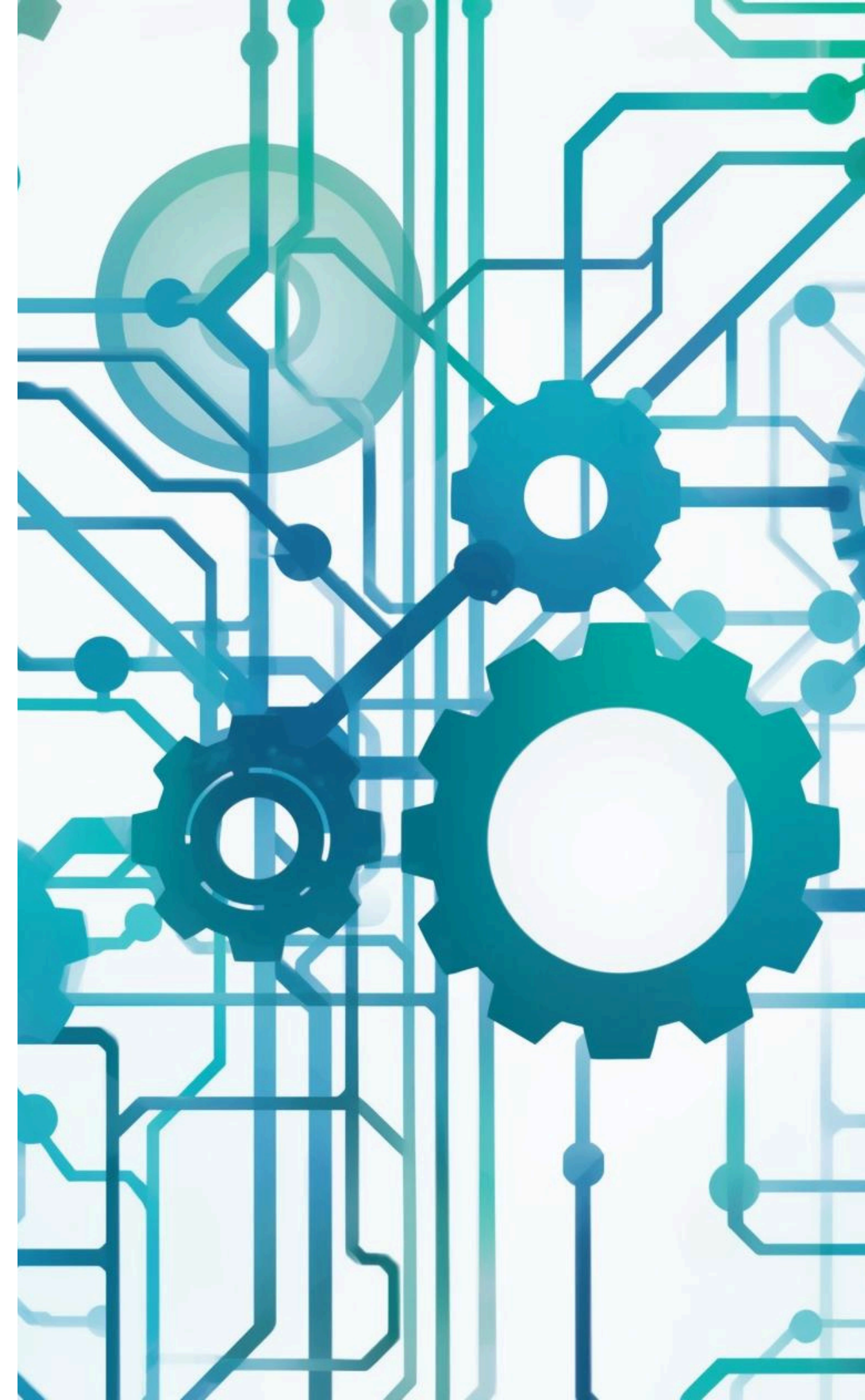
Innovation vs. Precaution

Innovation-first approach (US tendency):

- Let technology develop, regulate harms as they emerge
- Avoid stifling beneficial innovation
- Trust markets and iteration

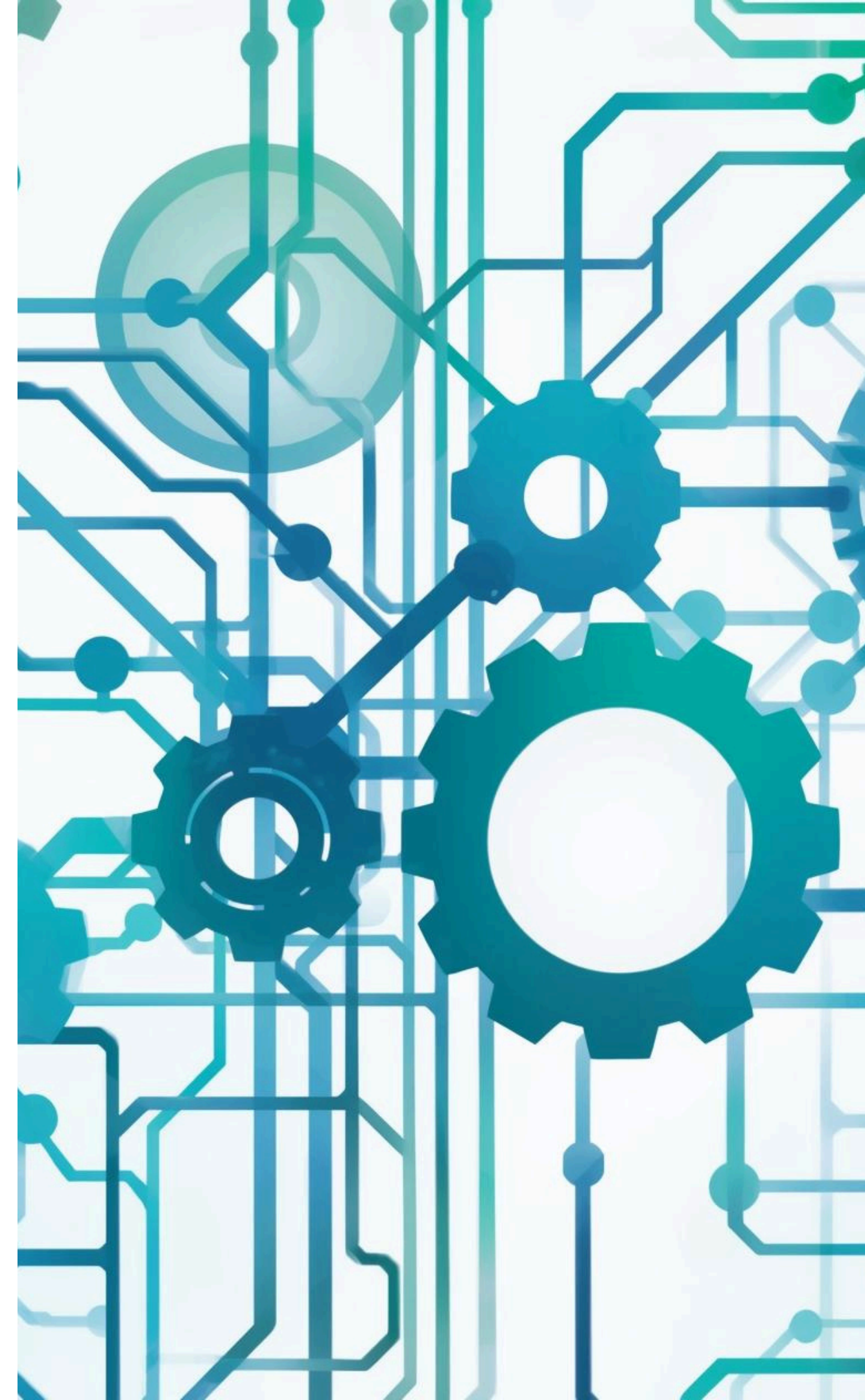
Precautionary approach (EU tendency):

- Regulate before harms materialize
- Better safe than sorry
- Democratic deliberation before deployment



Innovation vs. Precaution

Question: Which errs in the right direction? Is false positive (over-regulating beneficial AI) or false negative (under-regulating harmful AI) worse?



Centralization vs. Decentralization of Power

Centralization (few powerful systems):

- Easier to regulate and monitor
- Can enforce safety standards
- Economies of scale in safety research
- Risk: Concentration of power, single points of failure



Centralization vs. Decentralization of Power

Decentralization (many smaller systems):

- Democratic access
- Innovation from diverse sources
- Resilience (no single point of failure)
- Risk: Harder to govern, misuse more likely



National Security vs. Openness

Tension between:

- Open research and international collaboration (better for safety, science)
- Export controls and secrecy (national security concerns)

Current trend: Increasing restrictions

- Export controls on AI chips (US to China)
- Visa restrictions on researchers
- Classification of AI research



National Security vs. Openness

Questions:

- Does securitization make us safer or less safe?
- Can we have international cooperation on safety while competing on capabilities?



Questions

Legitimate Authority:

Who should have the power to decide how AI is developed and deployed?

- Engineers?
- Companies?
- Governments?
- Citizens?
- Why?



Questions

Corporate Power:

- Are AI companies too powerful?
- Should they be broken up, nationalized, heavily regulated, or left largely alone?
- What criteria should guide this decision?



Questions

Regulatory Tradeoffs:

- Would you prefer over-regulation that slows beneficial AI, or under-regulation that risks serious harms?
- How certain do you need to be about risks before regulating?



Questions

Democratic Input:

- How can non-experts meaningfully participate in AI governance decisions? Or should technical decisions be left to experts?

